

LAB 3: Modular Functions, Files Inclusion, & Core Strings

- **Syllabus Alignment:** Unit 1: Introduction & Unit 2: Strings and Arrays (16 LHs combined) — Functions, Including/Requiring Files, Strings, and String Functions
- **Lab Objectives:** To practice writing reusable, parameterized functions, manage code layout division across different files, and implement native string manipulation tools.
- **Lab Questions:**
 1. **Parametric Return Functions:** Define a custom PHP function named `addNumbers()` that takes two values as arguments, computes their arithmetic total, and returns the result to the caller.
 2. **Layout Modularization:** Create a clean web template layout by defining a parent script that pulls in separate header, content, and footer modules using the file inclusion tools (`include`, `require`, `include_once`, `require_once`). Write a short note in your lab report explaining the difference between `include` and `require` when a file is missing.
 3. **String Processing Suite:** Write a single script that processes text values using at least 8 native string functions, demonstrating utilities like character counting, pattern positioning, case transformation, slicing, and string replacements (e.g., `strlen()`, `strrev()`, `strpos()`, `strtolower()`, `strtoupper()`, `substr()`, and `str_replace()`).